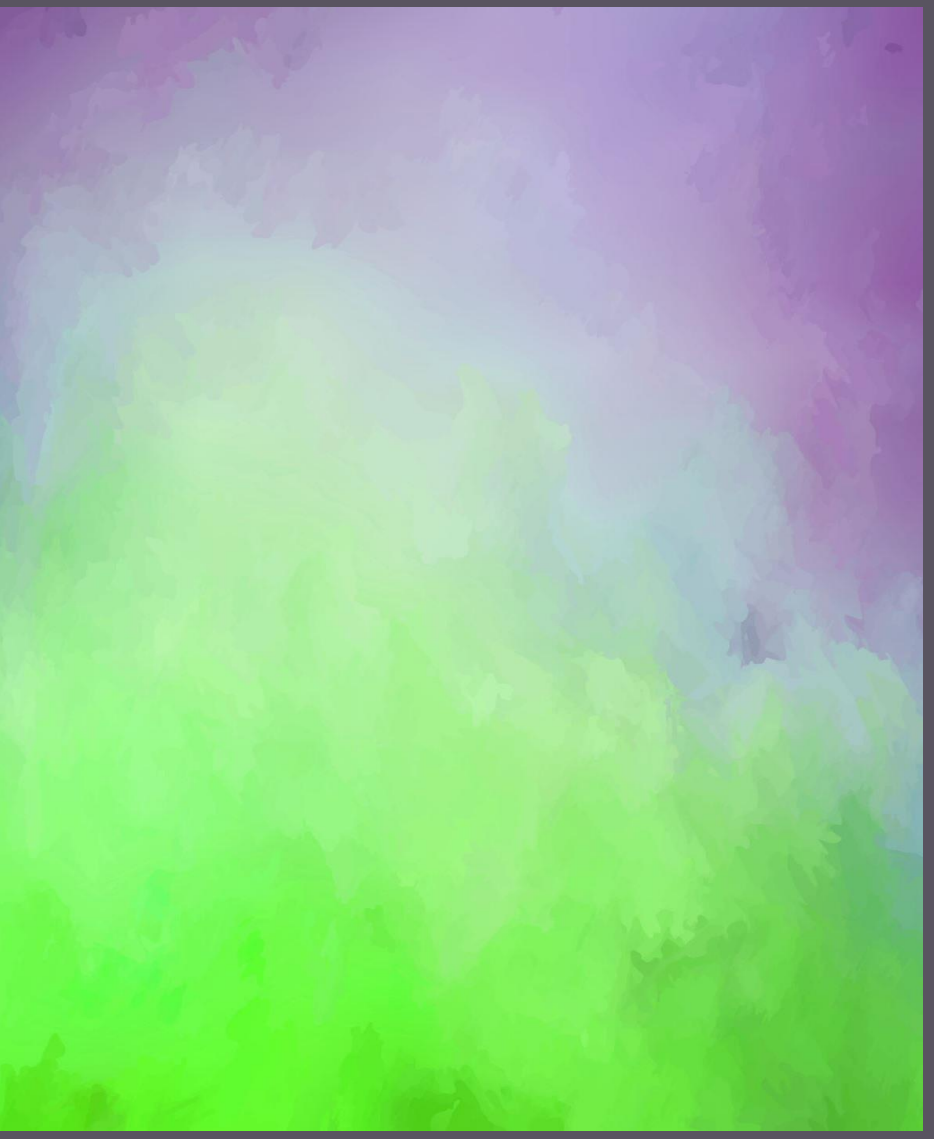


HEALING & WHOLING

Foundations in Self-Work for Intimacy Coaches

Kai Cheng Thom, MSW, MSc, QMed,
Certified Somatic Sex Educator



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Define intimacy coaching
2. Opening, Reframing & De-shaming intimacy and sexuality
3. Understand Sexual & Gender Diversity
4. Engage somatic practices for connecting with longing, desire, and pleasure

The Sacred Pause

for empowered choice & voice

1) **stop and breathe**

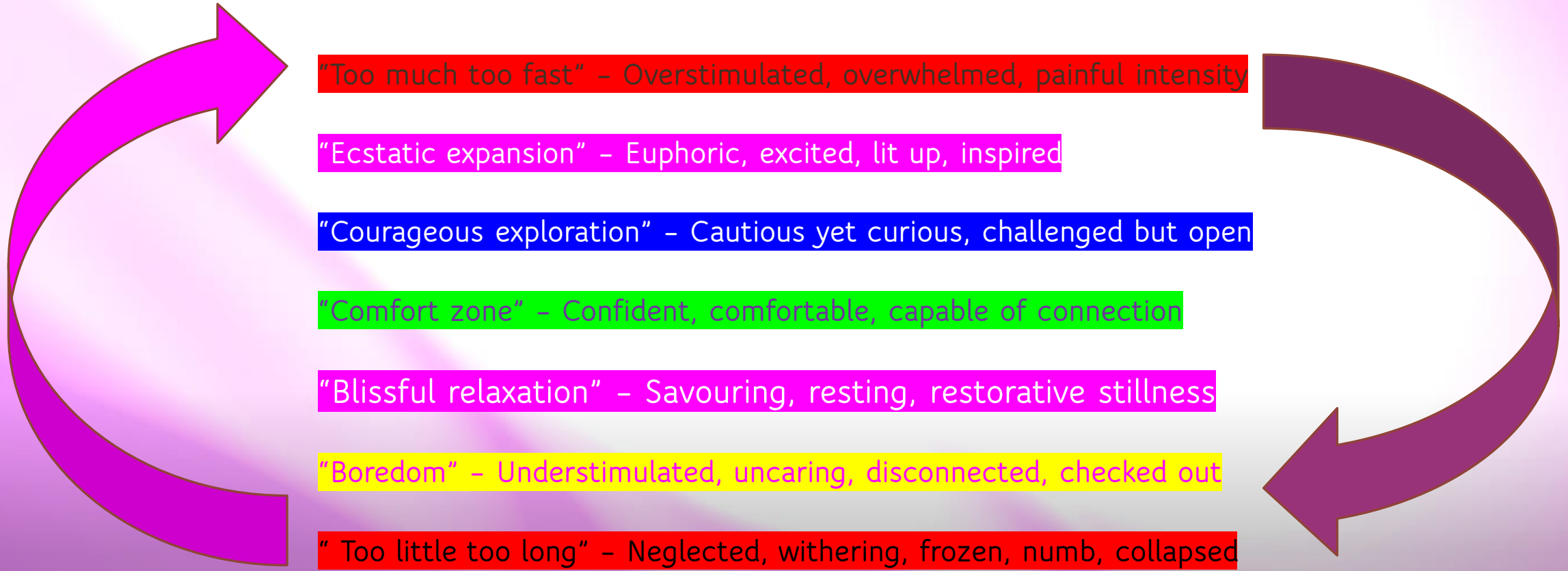


2) **Scan your body** - are you feeling a **yes, no, or maybe?**

3) Make a decision based on **empowered choice and voice** - will you move forward, stop, or do something else?

Graphic by
Kai Cheng Thom

The Neural "Learning Zone"



"Too much too fast" – Overstimulated, overwhelmed, painful intensity

"Ecstatic expansion" – Euphoric, excited, lit up, inspired

"Courageous exploration" – Cautious yet curious, challenged but open

"Comfort zone" – Confident, comfortable, capable of connection

"Blissful relaxation" – Savouring, resting, restorative stillness

"Boredom" – Understimulated, uncaring, disconnected, checked out

" Too little too long" – Neglected, withering, frozen, numb, collapsed

ORIENTING TO DESIRE

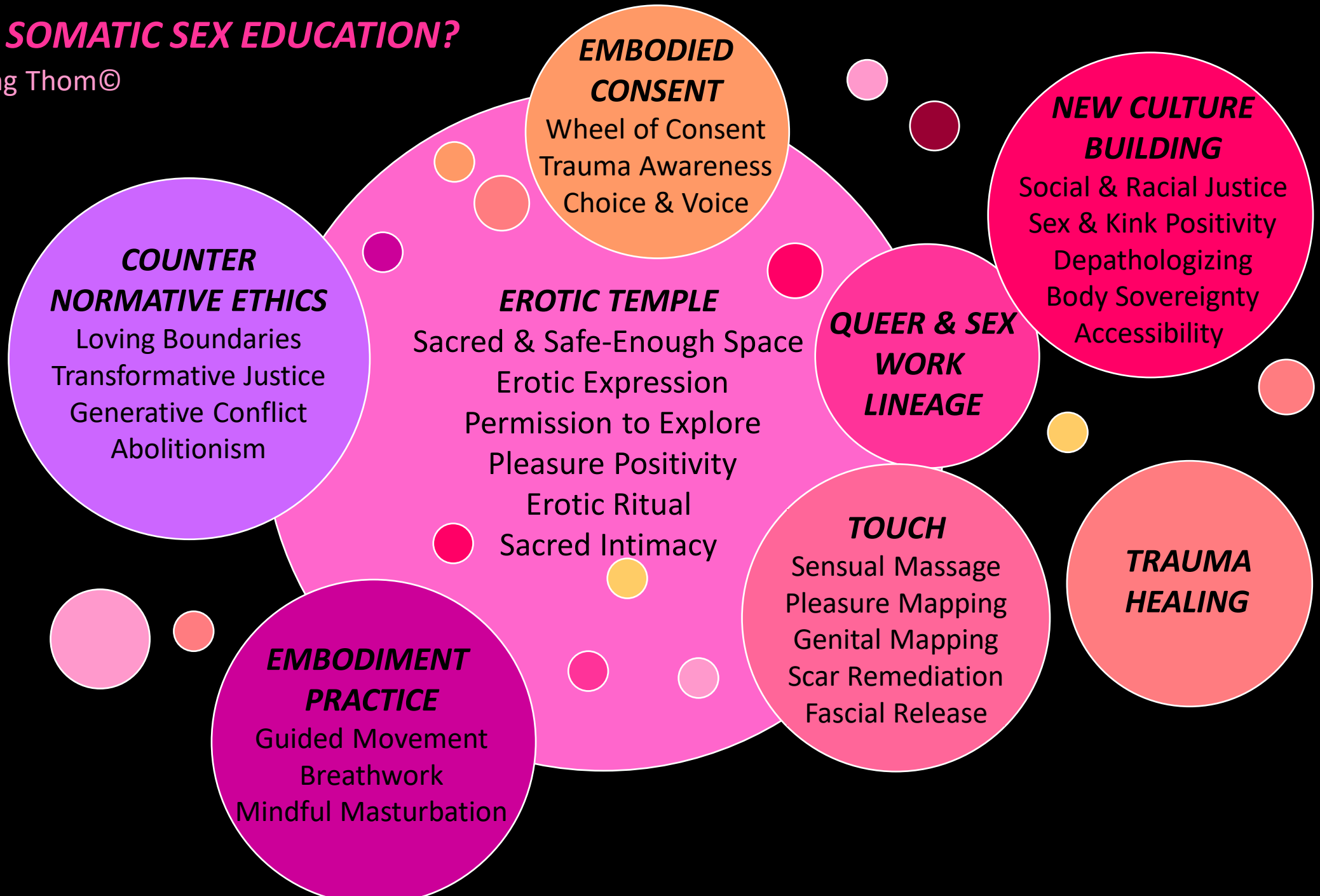
Somatic Practice

I CAN SUPPORT MYSELF TO BE IN MY NEURAL LEARNING ZONE BY...



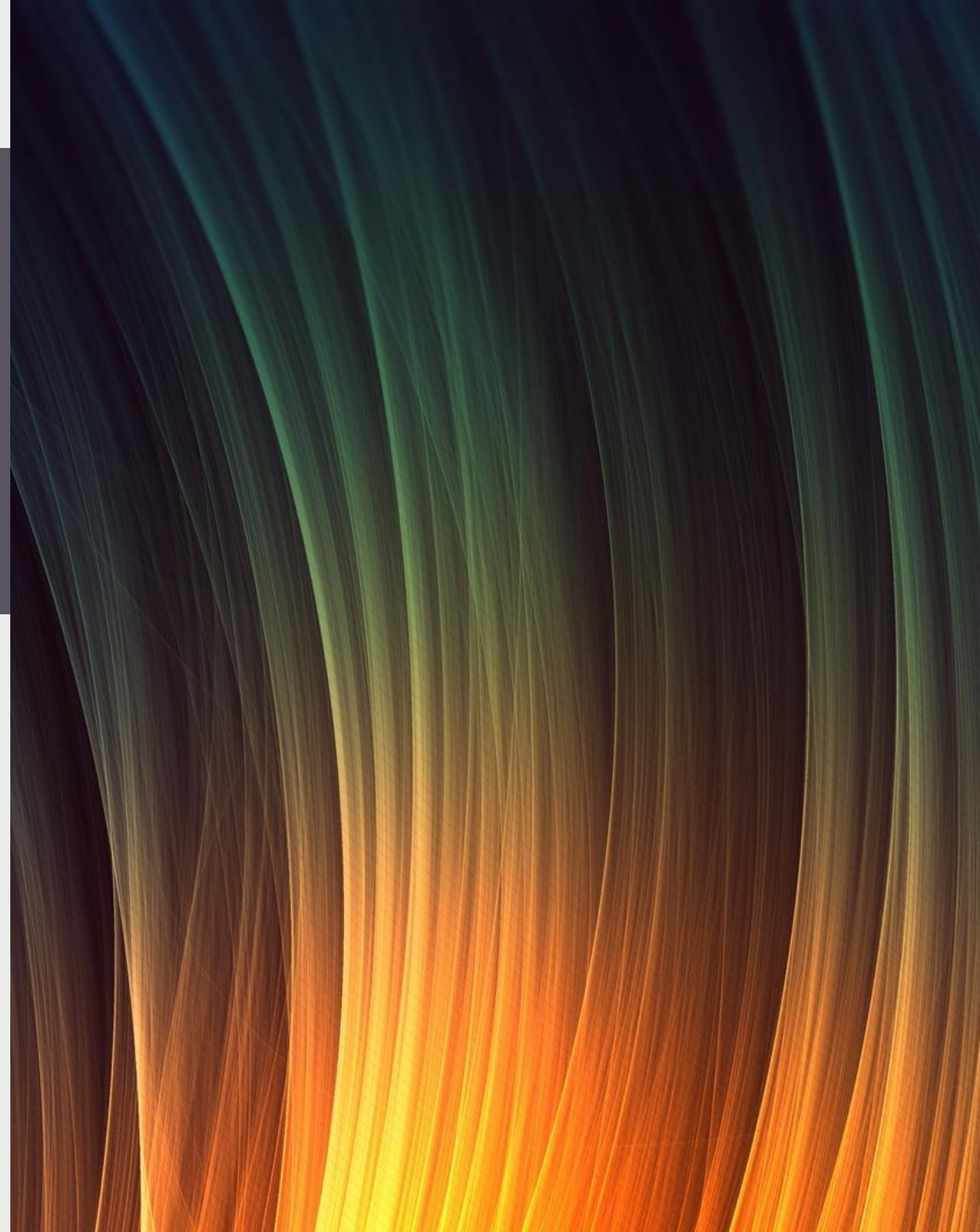
WHAT IS SOMATIC SEX EDUCATION?

by Kai Cheng Thom©



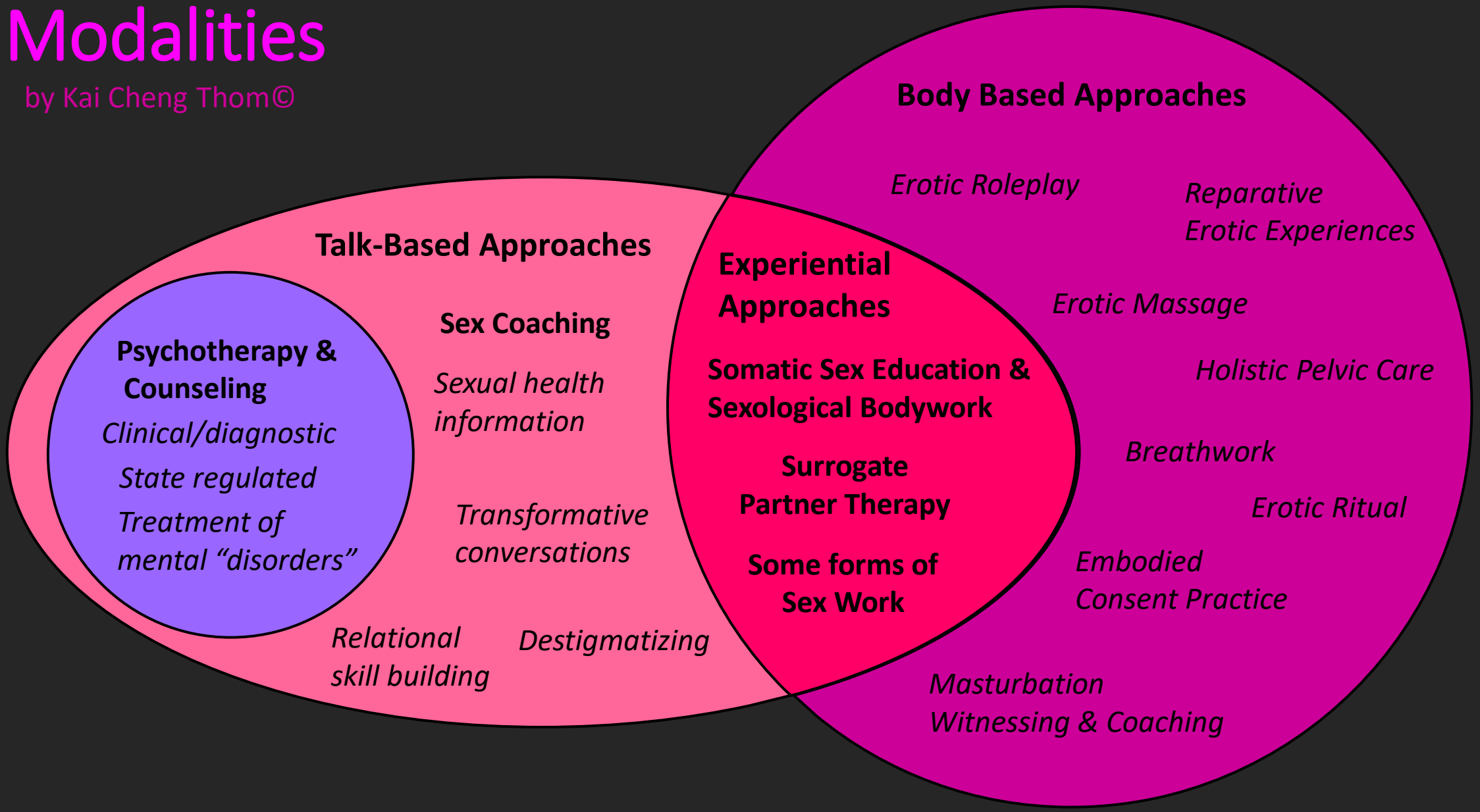
WHAT IS EMBODIED INTIMACY COACHING?

A body-based, non-clinical approach to supporting individuals, couples (or triads or polycules), and groups experience intimate and erotic healing, wholeness, and happiness in relationships and/or with themselves based on their unique needs, desires, and orientation to the world. Methods include conversation, movement, breath, vocalization, and touch.



Erotic Healing Modalities

by Kai Cheng Thom©





THERE IS SO MUCH UNTAPPED CAPACITY FOR PLEASURE IN OUR BODIES AND OUR LIVES. EROTIC ENERGY CAN NOURISH US PHYSICALLY, MENTALLY, EMOTIONALLY AND SPIRITUALLY—WHETHER WE ARE WITH OR WITHOUT AN "IDEAL PARTNER."

Caffyn Jesse, Somatic Sex Educator,

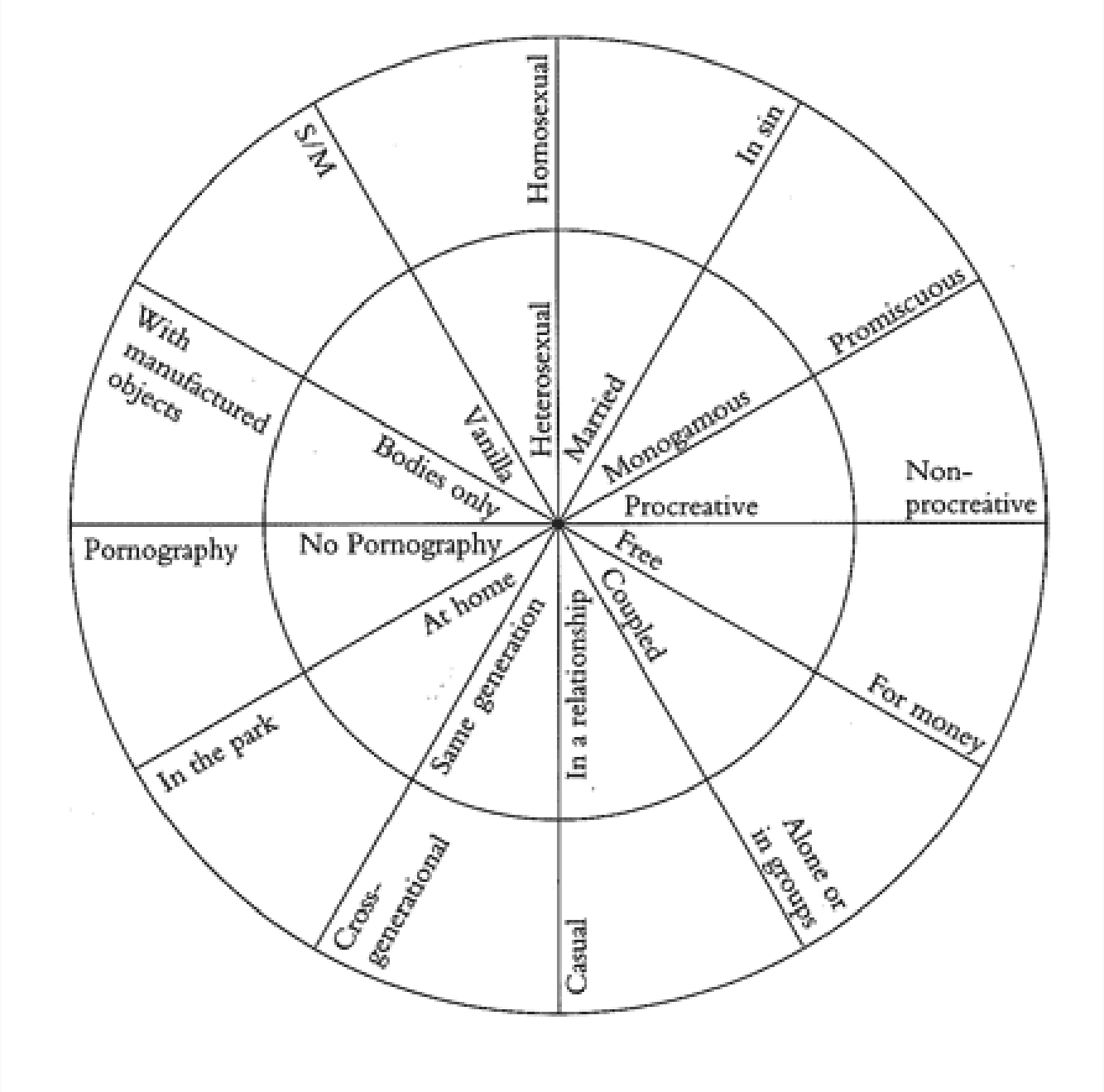
www.erospirit.ca

OPENING SACRED SPACE

Somatic Practice

GAYLE RUBIN'S CHARMED CIRCLE

Who is "allowed" to have sex? Under what circumstances? Who "deserves" intimacy and relationships? Who lives inside the charmed circle and who lives outside?





REFLECTION: WHEN YOU WERE GROWING UP, WHAT DID YOU LEARN ABOUT SEXUALITY? WHERE DID THESE LESSONS COME FROM? WHERE DO THOSE LESSONS LIVE IN YOUR BODY NOW?



REFLECTION: WHEN YOU WERE GROWING UP, WHAT DID YOU LEARN ABOUT ROMANTIC RELATIONSHIPS? WHERE DID THESE LESSONS COME FROM? WHERE DO THOSE LESSONS LIVE IN YOUR BODY NOW?

SEXUALITY AS A SPECTRUM

Human sexuality and asexuality may be conceptualized as a spectrum consisting of multiple dimensions, through which individuals may shift fluidly over time.

Sexual desire and behavior can be directed towards oneself or towards others, and may be oriented towards particular genders or not.

Romantic feelings and sexuality may be more or less connected depending on the individual.



Further Resources

https://www.thetrevorproject.org/resources/category/sexual-orientation/

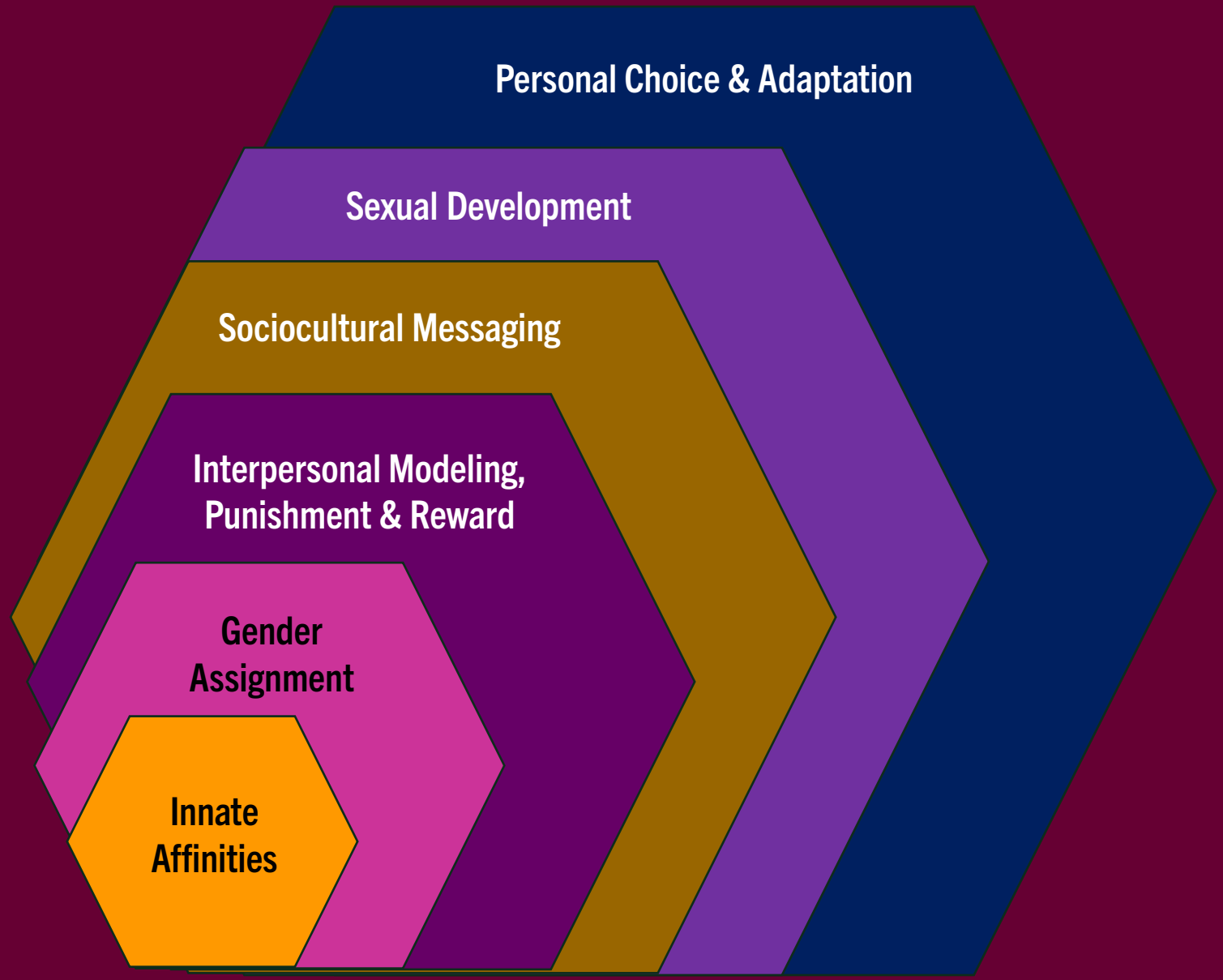
https://lgbtq.unc.edu/resources/exploring-identities/asexuality-attraction-and-romantic-orientation/

UNLABELLING PRACTICE

Somatic Practice – credited to Captain Snowdown, Faculty at the Institute for the Study of Somatic Sex Education

SOMATIC GENDER SHAPING

by Kai Cheng Thom©



THE GENDER GALAXY

A Metaphor for Gender Diversity




DESHAMING
PRACTICE